

Diploma in

PHOTOSHOP



SUMMARY NOTES

Brush Tools Essentials
Lesson 11 & 12

BRUSHES ARE AN ESSENTIAL PART OF PHOTOSHOP. WE USE THEM IN OUR COSMETIC RETOUCHING, OUR LAYER MASKS, AND FOR DIGITAL PAINTING. WHILE SIMPLE IN THEORY, WHEN WE EXPLORE BRUSHES IN DEPTH WE CAN UNLOCK THEIR CREATIVE POTENTIAL.

3.01 Brush Tools & Pre-sets

3.02 Brush Tool Options

3.03 Brush Tool Dynamics

3.04 Installing & Creating

Brush Tools Essentials

BRUSH TOOLS & PRE-SETS

“At its most basic, the Photoshop brush tool is used for drawing lines and shapes in any color on a layer in your document using strokes.”

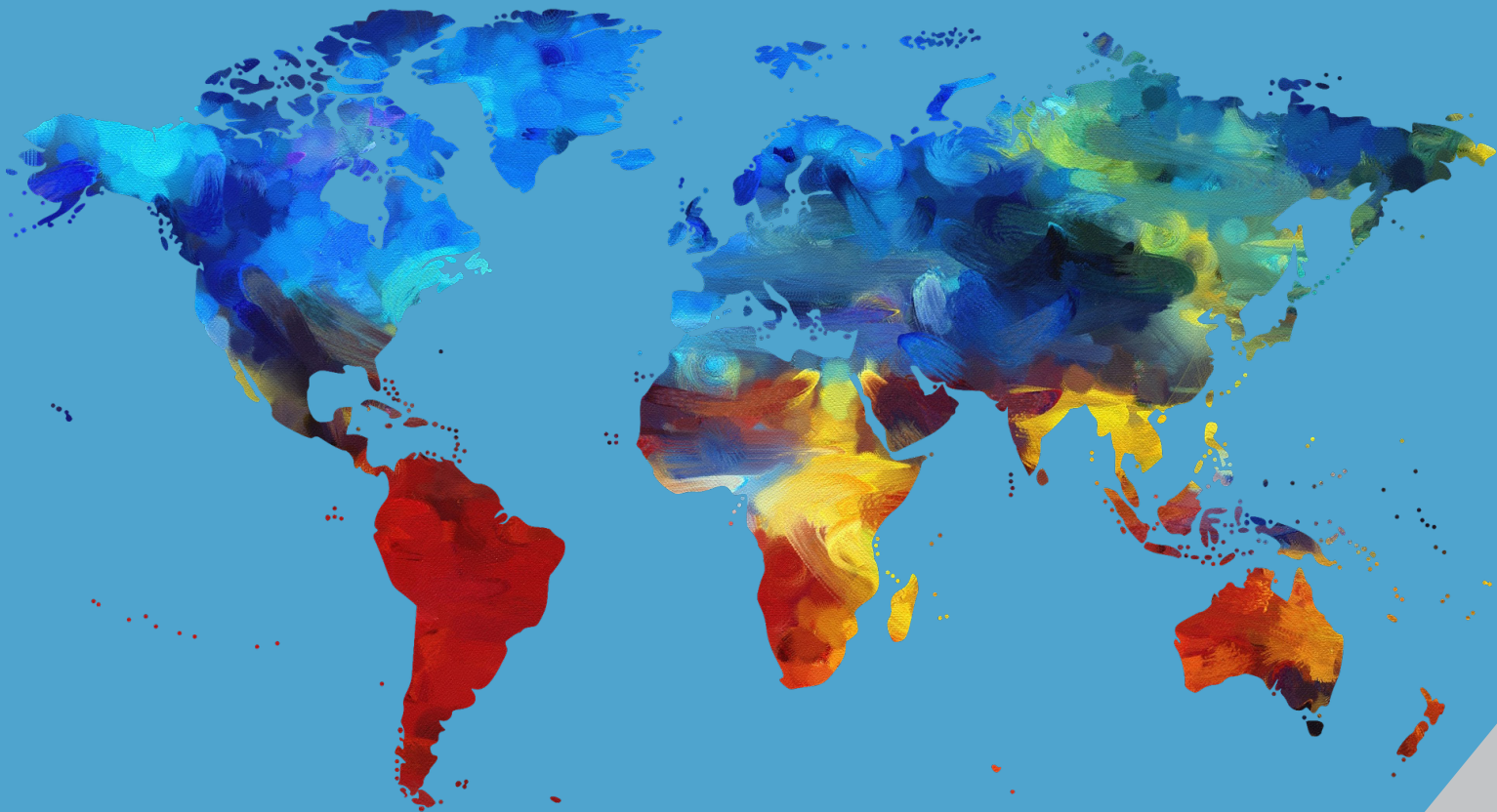
Photoshop brushes are a fantastic time-saver for digital artists. They enable you to quickly create rich artwork without having to draw all the individual design elements each time. Simple yet versatile, brushes let you accomplish some pretty cool things with a couple clicks of your mouse.

At its most basic, the Photoshop brush tool is used for drawing lines and shapes in any color on a layer in your document using strokes. After selecting a brush, you can draw simply by clicking the left mouse button a single time, or by holding it down and dragging your cursor around the page to create multiple marks with a single stroke. Despite the term brush, you can use brushes for much more than just replicating physical media like paints. In fact, brushes can be used for everything from textures and patterns to lighting. The ease of use and versatility of this tool make it a handy resource for both the novice and the expert designer to add depth to your projects.

When you change the size, shape, or hardness of a preset brush, the change is temporary. The next time you choose that preset, the brush uses its original settings. To make your changes permanent, you need to create a new preset. A preset brush is a saved brush tip with defined characteristics, such as size, shape, and hardness. You can save preset brushes with the characteristics you use often. You can also save tool presets for the Brush tool that you can select from the Tool Preset menu in the options bar

Brush Pre-sets

Brush Types			
Soft Round	Hard round	Pressure	Flat Angle
Stiff Brush	Water Colours	Flat Point	Crayons
Charcoals	Pastels	Pencils	Splatter
Chalks	Star Shape	Grass Brush	Scatter Brushes
Dry Brush	Oil	Rough	Custom



BRUSH TOOL OPTIONS

Size:

Determines the size of the brush. The brush size can be adjusted using the slider, the type box or the shortcut keys

Hardness:

Determines how hard the brush edge is. The hardness can be changed with a slider, the type box or shortcut keys.

Tip Angle:

Determines the angle of the brush tip. This is changed by rotating the circular shape in the pre-set box.

Brush Thickness:

Determines the thickness or thinness of a brush. This can be changed by altering the circle with in the pre-set box.

Photoshop Brushes:

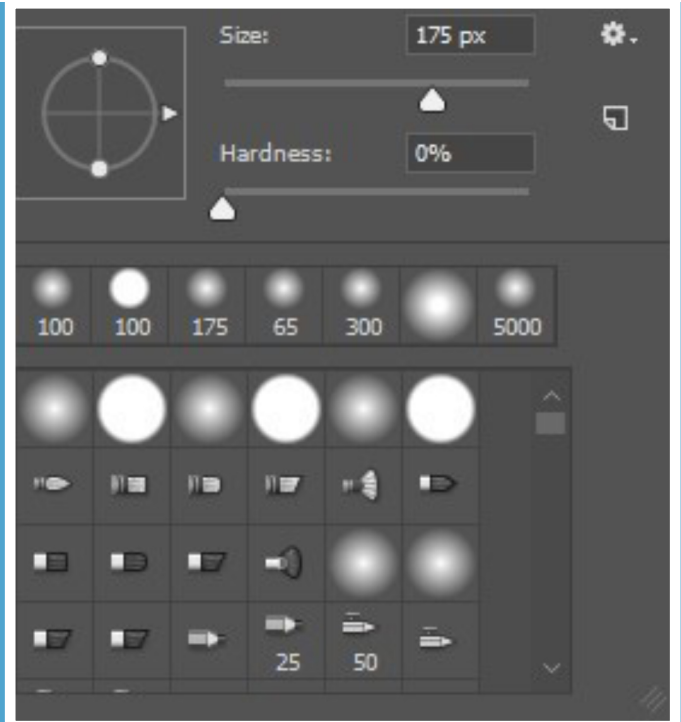
Photoshop has a range of default brushes to use. These include default hard & soft brushes, to different simulated brush types.

Opacity:

Opacity from the options bar works independently to the opacity of the layer.

Flow:

Flow allows you to build up repeatedly. A lot like ink on a piece of paper. The more times you go over something with Flow the more you are building on top of the image.



BRUSH TOOL DYNAMICS

Shape Dynamics:

Shape dynamics determine the variance of brush marks in a stroke. Size Jitter and Control specifies how the size of brush marks vary in a stroke. Roundness Jitter and Control specifies how the roundness of brush marks varies in a stroke.

Scattering:

Brush scattering determines the number and placement of marks in a stroke.

Texture:

A textured brush uses a pattern to make strokes look as if they are painted on textured canvas.

Dual Brush:

A dual brush combines two tips to create brush marks. The second brush texture is applied within the brush stroke of the primary brush; only the areas where both brush strokes intersect are painted.

Colour Dynamics:

Colour dynamics determine how the colour of paint changes over the course of a stroke.

Transfer:

Transfer brush options determine how paint changes over the course of a stroke.

Brush Pose:

Brush Pose allows the user to override the stylus input.

Noise:

Adds additional randomness to individual brush tips. This option is most effective when applied to soft brush tips (brush tips that contain grey values).

Wet Edges:

Causes paint to build up along the edges of the brush stroke, creating a watercolour effect.

Build-up:

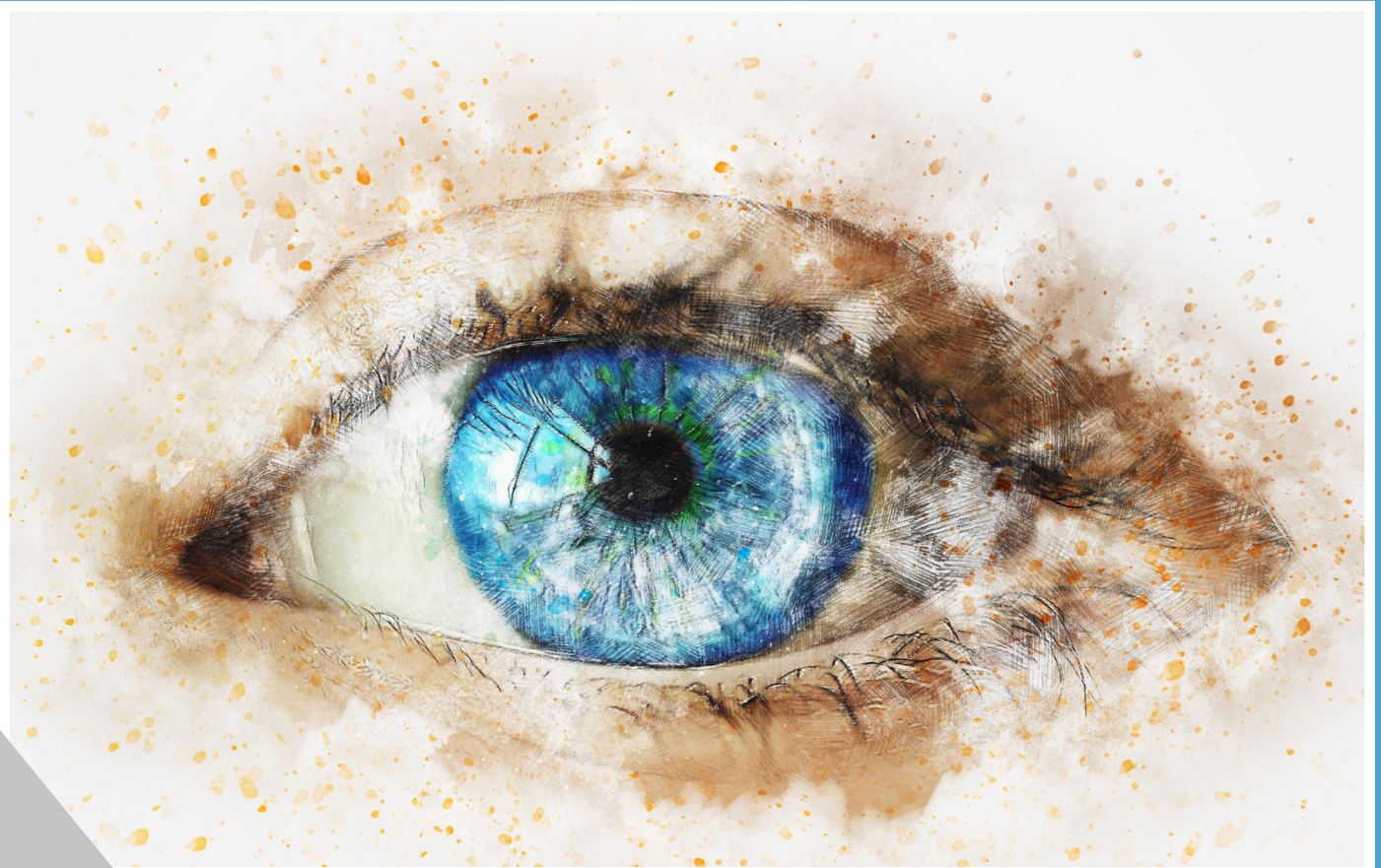
Applies gradual tones to an image, simulating traditional airbrush techniques. The Airbrush option in the Brush panel corresponds to the Airbrush option in the options bar.

Smoothing:

Produces smoother curves in brush strokes. This option is most effective when you are painting quickly with a stylus; however, it may produce a slight lag time in stroke rendering.

Protect Texture:

Applies the same pattern and scale to all brush pre-sets that have a texture. Select this option to simulate a consistent canvas texture when painting with multiple, textured brush tips.



INSTALLING & CREATING

Installing a brush

Brushes can be installed in various ways:

1. From Brush options or Pre-sets use the COG/MENU > Load Brushes. Find the file and choose.
2. From a downloaded file, you can double click the file and it will store in an open Photoshop program.



Creating a Brush

Creating a brush requires the use of selections.

- Select the area you wish with a selection tool.
- Magic wand will work for scatter brushes
- Edit> Define Brush Pre-set.

Tips: For optional attributes use the Brush Tip dynamics to create interesting brushes. It is also possible to use images, shapes and text layers to define Brush Pre-sets. Make sure to rasterise layers when selecting text or shapes.





THANK YOU